

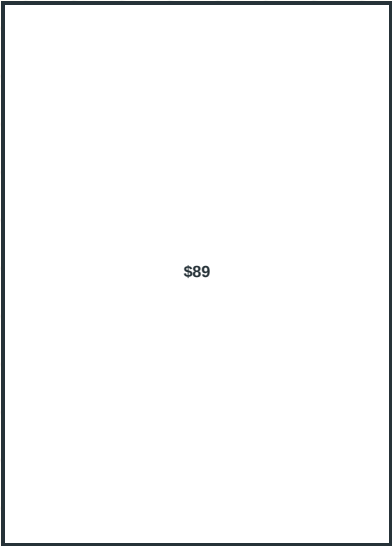
Hanging File Story Decision Point Card Pack

Sixteen hanging-file cards help writers compare two pretend paths, choose one path, write a consequence note, and add a broad file label.

Audience: Families, homeschool groups, tutors, and adult-led writing tables for writers ages 7-11.

Format: 16 printable hanging file story decision-point cards plus adult guide tools, decision-point routines, take-home decision slips, and optional adult prompts

Family-safe printable writing pages for adult-led, offline decision practice.



\$89

Included

- 16 printable hanging file decision point cards
- Adult setup guide
- Fictional decision-point safety notes
- Character choice prompts
- Two-path comparison prompts
- Compare clue prompts
- Chosen path prompts
- Consequence note prompts
- File label prompts
- Six adult-led decision-point routines
- Ten take-home decision slips

Decision point coaching

Hanging File Decision Point Adult Guide

- Set out one hanging file, blank pages, pencils, and a decision-point card before the adult-led paper start.
- Choose one fictional character choice and keep every path, clue, and consequence note invented.
- Move through character choice, path one, path two, clue to compare, chosen path, consequence note, and hanging-file label in order.
- Keep the adult in charge of the hanging file while the writer writes or dictates short paper lines.
- Use pretend characters, broad places, and invented actions only; skip real names, real places, and personal facts.
- Close by reading the chosen path, adding one consequence note, and writing the hanging-file label for later adult-led paper planning.

Use one hanging file card at a time. Keep every choice broad, invented, paper-only, and guided by an adult.

Sixteen decision card worlds

Pick a world image, then compare two fictional paths and choose one consequence note.



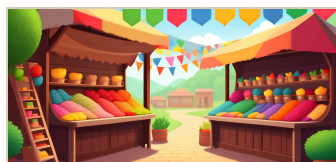
AGES 7-9

Acorn Avenue Errand Office



AGES 7-9

Button Bakery Map Mix-Up



AGES 7-8

Mitten Market Lost Ticket



AGES 7-9

Penny Path Compass Shop



AGES 7-9

Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor



AGES 8-10

Compost Clock Workshop



AGES 8-10

Orchard Pulley Post



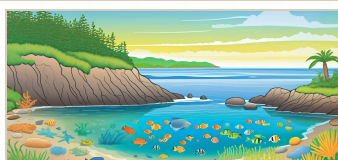
AGES 8-10

Pantry Measurement Mystery



AGES 8-10

Pond Bridge Blueprint Club



AGES 8-10

Tidepool Timekeepers Lab



AGES 10-11

Almost Invention Workshop



AGES 10-11

Appendix Archive Lab



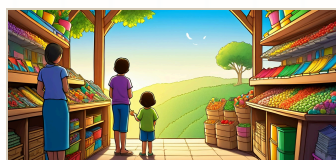
AGES 10-11

Blue Pencil Observatory



AGES 10-11

Clue Label Tower Museum



AGES 10-11

Margin Note Market



AGES 10-11

Revision River Ferry

Choose the hanging file routine

SHORT FIRST-PAGE SETUP Character Choice Start Hanging file, blank page, pencil, and character choice slip. 1. The adult opens the hanging file and points to the character choice blank: _____. 2. The writer names one fictional character for the paper plan: _____. 3. The adult asks what choice is standing in front of that character: _____. 4. The writer writes or dictates one character choice line on paper: _____. The decision point starts with this fictional character choice: _____.	FIRST OPTION PASS Path One Fold Hanging file, current page, pencil, and path one slip. 1. The adult rereads the character choice line from the page: _____. 2. The writer invents one path the fictional character could take: _____. 3. The adult asks what makes path one clear on paper: _____. 4. The writer writes path one on the slip and places it in the hanging file: _____. Path one gives the character this possible choice: _____.
SECOND OPTION PASS Path Two Fold Hanging file, path one slip, blank path two slip, and pencil. 1. The adult points from path one to the path two blank: _____. 2. The writer invents a different path the fictional character could take: _____. 3. The adult asks how path two is different from path one: _____. 4. The writer writes path two and tucks it beside path one: _____. Path two gives the character this other possible choice: _____.	PAPER COMPARISON PASS Compare Clue Sort Hanging file, path one slip, path two slip, clue-to-compare note, and pencil. 1. The adult lays path one and path two side by side on the table: _____. 2. The writer chooses one clue to compare before a path is picked: _____. 3. The adult asks what the clue shows about each path: _____. 4. The writer writes the clue to compare on the note: _____. The clue to compare says this about the two paths: _____.
CHOICE CLOSE PASS Chosen Path Slip Hanging file, two path slips, clue note, chosen path slip, and pencil. 1. The adult rereads path one, path two, and the clue to compare: _____. 2. The writer picks one chosen path for the fictional character: _____. 3. The adult asks why that path fits the character choice: _____. 4. The writer writes the chosen path on the slip: _____. The chosen path for this decision point is: _____.	HANGING-FILE WRAP Consequence Label Close Hanging file, chosen path slip, consequence note, label strip, and pencil. 1. The adult places the chosen path slip at the front of the hanging file: _____. 2. The writer names one fictional consequence note for that chosen path: _____. 3. The adult asks what hanging-file label will help find this decision point later: _____. 4. The writer writes the consequence note and hanging-file label: _____. The hanging-file label closes this decision point as: _____.

Try one decision later

TAKE-HOME DECISION SLIP Decision slip 1 Adult: open the hanging file and ask for one fictional character choice: _____.	TAKE-HOME DECISION SLIP Decision slip 2 Writer: the fictional character choice is: _____.
TAKE-HOME DECISION SLIP Decision slip 3 Adult: ask what path one could be on the paper plan: _____.	TAKE-HOME DECISION SLIP Decision slip 4 Writer: path one is: _____.
TAKE-HOME DECISION SLIP Decision slip 5 Adult: ask what different path two could be: _____.	TAKE-HOME DECISION SLIP Decision slip 6 Writer: path two is: _____.
TAKE-HOME DECISION SLIP Decision slip 7 Adult: ask for one clue to compare before choosing: _____.	TAKE-HOME DECISION SLIP Decision slip 8 Writer: the clue to compare is: _____.
TAKE-HOME DECISION SLIP Decision slip 9 Adult: reread both paths and ask which chosen path fits the character choice: _____.	TAKE-HOME DECISION SLIP Decision slip 10 Writer: the consequence note and hanging-file label are: _____.

- Optional adult prompts
- Optional adult-led paper prompt: the fictional character choice is _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: path one could lead to _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: path two could lead to _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the clue to compare is _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the chosen path should be _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the consequence note says _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the hanging-file label can name _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the next decision point can start with _____.

Acorn Avenue Errand Office Story Decision Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out one hanging file, blank page, pencil, and pretend errand-office decision point card beside the writer: _____.

Writer: keep the Acorn Avenue helper and every errand office detail invented while you decide between two paper paths: _____.



Acorn Avenue Errand Office

Choice

Choice: name the fictional helper's errand-office choice at the decision point: _____.

Path two

Path two: write a different possible paper path the helper could try with the same errand note: _____.

Chosen path

Chosen path: choose one path for the helper and write why it fits this made-up errand scene: _____.

File label

File label: write a broad hanging-file label for this Acorn Avenue decision point: _____.

Path one

Path one: write the first possible paper path the helper could try with the errand note: _____.

Compare clue

Compare clue: write one pretend clue that helps compare the two errand-office paths: _____.

Consequence note

Consequence note: write one small result note from the chosen errand-office path: _____.

Quiet option: fill only the choice, compare clue, and file label blanks before choosing a path later: _____, **Take-home line:** restart this paper decision point later with one pretend Acorn Avenue errand choice: _____.

Button Bakery Map Mixup Story Decision Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: place one hanging file, blank page, pencil, and pretend button-map decision point card where the writer can reach them: _____.

Writer: invent the button bakery, map marks, and helper choice on paper without using real place details: _____.



Button Bakery Map Mix-Up

Choice

Choice: name the fictional helper's choice when two button-map marks point to different ideas: _____.

Path two

Path two: write a second possible paper path that uses a different button-map clue: _____.

Chosen path

Chosen path: choose one path for the helper and write the reason it fits the map mixup: _____.

File label

File label: write a broad hanging-file label for this Button Bakery decision point: _____.

Path one

Path one: write the first possible paper path the helper could follow from the button mark: _____.

Compare clue

Compare clue: write one pretend map clue, button color, or label that helps compare the paths: _____.

Consequence note

Consequence note: write one small result note from the chosen button-map path: _____.

Quiet option: draw a tiny button mark, then fill the choice and file label blanks: _____. **Take-home line:** continue this paper decision point later with one pretend button-map choice: _____.

Mitten Market Lost Ticket Story Decision Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set one hanging file, blank page, pencil, and pretend mitten-ticket decision point card on the table: _____.

Writer: keep the ticket, mitten stalls, and helper made-up while the decision stays paper-only: _____.



Mitten Market Lost Ticket

Choice

Choice: name the fictional helper's choice when the pretend ticket could belong in two places: _____.

Path two

Path two: write a second possible paper path for sorting the ticket mixup: _____.

Chosen path

Chosen path: choose one path for the helper and write why it fits the mitten market scene: _____.

File label

File label: write a broad hanging-file label for this Mitten Market decision point: _____.

Path one

Path one: write the first possible paper path for checking the mitten ticket: _____.

Compare clue

Compare clue: write one pretend clue that helps compare the two ticket paths: _____.

Consequence note

Consequence note: write one small result note from the chosen ticket path: _____.

Quiet option: fill only the choice, path one, and file label blanks before adding more: _____.

Take-home line: start another paper decision point later with one pretend mitten-ticket choice: _____.

Penny Path Compass Shop Story Decision Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: place one hanging file, blank page, pencil, and pretend compass-shop decision point card beside the writer: _____.

Writer: invent the compass shop, penny marks, and helper choice while every path stays on paper: _____.



Penny Path Compass Shop

Choice

Choice: name the fictional helper's choice when the pretend compass points toward two ideas: _____.

Path two

Path two: write a different possible paper path the helper could try with the penny mark: _____.

Chosen path

Chosen path: choose one path for the helper and write why it fits the compass shop scene: _____.

File label

File label: write a broad hanging-file label for this Penny Path decision point: _____.

Path one

Path one: write the first possible paper path the helper could try with the compass clue: _____.

Compare clue

Compare clue: write one pretend clue that helps compare the compass path and penny-mark path: _____.

Consequence note

Consequence note: write one small result note from the chosen compass-shop path: _____.

Quiet option: fill the choice and compare clue blanks, then let the chosen path wait: _____, **Take-home line:** continue this paper decision point later with one pretend compass-shop choice: _____.

Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor Story Decision Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out one hanging file, blank page, pencil, and pretend spoon-ferry decision point card: _____.

Writer: keep the harbor, spoon ferry, lunchbox tag, and helper choice invented on the page: _____.



Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor

Choice Choice: name the fictional helper's choice when the spoon ferry can carry one paper tag first: _____ _____	Path one Path one: write the first possible paper path the helper could send across the harbor: _____ _____
Path two Path two: write a second possible paper path the helper could send from another dock mark: _____ _____	Compare clue Compare clue: write one pretend harbor clue that helps compare the two spoon-ferry paths: _____ _____
Chosen path Chosen path: choose one path for the helper and write why it fits the harbor scene: _____ _____	Consequence note Consequence note: write one small result note from the chosen spoon-ferry path: _____ _____
File label File label: write a broad hanging-file label for this Spoon Ferry decision point: _____ _____	

Quiet option: fill the choice, path two, and file label blanks before finishing the rest: _____. **Take-home line:** reopen this paper decision point later with one pretend spoon-ferry choice: _____.

Compost Clock Workshop Story Decision Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: place one hanging file, blank page, pencil, and pretend compost-clock decision point card beside the paper: _____.

Writer: invent the clock workshop, compost dial, and helper choice while the whole decision stays paper-only: _____.



Compost Clock Workshop

Choice

Choice: name the fictional helper's choice when the compost clock offers two timing ideas: _____.

Path two

Path two: write a second possible paper path the helper could try with the compost tag clue: _____.

Chosen path

Chosen path: choose one path for the helper and write why it fits the compost-clock scene: _____.

File label

File label: write a broad hanging-file label for this Compost Clock decision point: _____.

Path one

Path one: write the first possible paper path the helper could try with the clock dial clue: _____.

Compare clue

Compare clue: write one pretend workshop clue that helps compare the two clock paths: _____.

Consequence note

Consequence note: write one small result note from the chosen workshop path: _____.

Quiet option: fill the compare clue and chosen path blanks first, then add the result note later: _____. **Take-home line:** continue this paper decision point later with one pretend compost-clock choice: _____.

Orchard Pulley Post Story Decision Point Card

Adult setup:

Adult: set out one hanging file, a blank orchard post page, a pencil, and a file label slip before the decision point starts: _____.

Writer:

invent an orchard post helper and keep the pulley, message cards, and decision point completely pretend on paper: _____.



Orchard Pulley Post

Choice Character choice: write the one choice the orchard post helper must make about a pretend pulley note: _____ _____	Path one Path one: write the first possible paper path the helper could try after reading the pulley note: _____ _____
Path two Path two: write the second possible paper path the helper could try instead: _____ _____	Compare clue Compare clue: name one clue the helper can compare before choosing, such as a ribbon mark, branch tag, or pulley arrow: _____ _____
Chosen path Chosen path: choose which paper path the helper follows and write why it fits the compare clue: _____ _____	Consequence note Consequence note: write the calm result of that choice on the pretend orchard post page: _____ _____
File label Hanging-file label: write the short pretend label for this orchard decision point: _____ _____	

Quiet option: adult reads the two path lines, and the writer fills only the chosen path blank: _____ . Take-home line: place the orchard post page in the hanging file with one consequence note ready for later: _____ .

Pantry Measurement Mystery Story Decision Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: place one hanging file beside a blank measurement page, a pencil, and a file label strip for the decision point: _____.

Writer: make up a shelf helper, a measuring ribbon, and a mystery choice that stays broad, fictional, and paper-only: _____.



Pantry Measurement Mystery

Choice Character choice: write the choice the shelf helper faces when two pretend measurement marks seem useful: _____.	Path one Path one: write the first possible paper path, such as checking the tall mark before the short mark: _____.
Path two Path two: write the second possible paper path, such as checking the corner note before the ribbon strip: _____.	Compare clue Compare clue: name the one measurement clue the helper compares before choosing a path: _____.
Chosen path Chosen path: choose one path and explain how the compare clue points that way: _____.	Consequence note Consequence note: write what changes on the pretend measurement page because of the helper's choice: _____.
File label Hanging-file label: write the short pretend label for this measurement mystery decision point: _____.	

Quiet option: adult points to the compare clue line, and the writer fills only the consequence note blank: _____. **Take-home line:** save the measurement page in the hanging file with the chosen path circled for later: _____.

Pond Bridge Blueprint Club Story Decision Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out one hanging file, a blank blueprint page, a pencil, and a file label slip for the decision point: _____.

Writer: invent a blueprint club helper and keep the pretend bridge choice on paper with adult guidance: _____.



Pond Bridge Blueprint Club

Choice

Character choice: write the decision the blueprint helper must make about a pretend bridge sketch: _____.

Path two

Path two: write the second possible paper path for revising the bridge sketch a different way: _____.

Chosen path

Chosen path: choose the paper path that best matches the compare clue and write the reason: _____.

File label

Hanging-file label: write the short pretend label for this blueprint club decision point: _____.

Path one

Path one: write the first possible paper path for revising the bridge sketch: _____.

Compare clue

Compare clue: name one blueprint clue the helper compares, such as a plank line, dotted mark, or folded corner: _____.

Consequence note

Consequence note: write the gentle result that follows from the blueprint helper's chosen path: _____.

Quiet option: adult circles one blueprint clue, and the writer fills only the chosen path line: _____.

Take-home line: file the blueprint page with one decision note and one label slip for later paper planning: _____.

Tidepool Timekeepers Lab Story Decision Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: open the hanging file, add a blank lab page, and place a file label strip beside the decision point card: _____.

Writer: invent a timekeeper helper, a pretend tidepool chart, and a paper-only decision with no real place details: _____.



Tidepool Timekeepers Lab

Choice Character choice: write the choice the timekeeper helper must make when two pretend chart marks point different ways: _____.	Path one Path one: write the first possible paper path the helper could follow on the tidepool chart: _____.
Path two Path two: write the second possible paper path the helper could follow instead: _____.	Compare clue Compare clue: name one chart clue the helper compares before choosing, such as a shell mark, wave line, or clock dot: _____.
Chosen path Chosen path: choose the chart path that fits the compare clue and write the helper's reason: _____.	Consequence note Consequence note: write the calm result that appears on the pretend lab page after the choice: _____.
File label Hanging-file label: write the short pretend label for this timekeepers lab decision point: _____.	

Quiet option: adult reads the chart clue, and the writer fills only the path one and path two blanks: _____.

Take-home line: keep the lab page in the hanging file with the chosen chart path ready to continue later: _____.

Almost Invention Workshop Story Decision Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set one hanging file, a blank workshop page, a pencil, and a file label slip beside the decision point prompt: _____.

Writer: invent a workshop helper with a gentle almost-invention and keep the decision point made up on paper: _____.



Almost Invention Workshop

Choice

Character choice: write the decision the workshop helper faces when an almost-invention can be changed two ways: _____.

Path two

Path two: write the second possible paper path for adjusting the almost-invention idea: _____.

Chosen path

Chosen path: choose the path the helper follows and explain how the compare clue supports it: _____.

File label

Hanging-file label: write the short pretend label for this workshop decision point: _____.

Path one

Path one: write the first possible paper path for adjusting the almost-invention idea: _____.

Compare clue

Compare clue: name one workshop clue the helper compares, such as a sketch arrow, gear note, or folded plan tab: _____.

Consequence note

Consequence note: write the result of the chosen path and what the helper understands next: _____.

Quiet option: adult points to the two path lines, and the writer fills only the compare clue blank: _____. **Take-home line:** tuck the workshop page into the hanging file with the consequence note facing up for later: _____.

Appendix Archive Lab Story Decision Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out one hanging file, blank page, pencil, and this card beside a pretend appendix archive tray: _____.

Writer: plan one invented lab character choice on paper and keep every archive detail made up with adult guidance: _____.



Appendix Archive Lab

Choice

Character choice: name the fictional archive helper's choice at the decision point: _____.

Path two

Path two: write a different possible path using another tab, margin clue, or archive note: _____.

Chosen path

Chosen path: choose the path the helper takes and explain the quiet reason: _____.

File label

Hanging-file label: write the broad pretend label for this archive decision point: _____.

Path one

Path one: write the first possible paper path through a note stack, appendix tab, or file marker: _____.

Compare clue

Compare clue: name one small clue that helps compare the two paths without blame or danger: _____.

Consequence note

Consequence note: write what changes in the pretend archive after that chosen path: _____.

Quiet option: fill only the character choice, two path names, and file label first: _____.

Take-home line: keep the page with the hanging file and add one new compare clue later:

Blue Pencil Observatory Story Decision Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: place this card, a hanging file, blank paper, and pencil beside a pretend blue-pencil chart: _____.

Writer: draft one invented observatory character choice on paper using only made-up chart details: _____.



Blue Pencil Observatory

Choice

Character choice: name the fictional chart keeper's choice at the observatory decision point: _____.

Path two

Path two: write a second possible path with a different chart mark or note strip: _____.

Chosen path

Chosen path: choose the path the keeper follows and give one calm reason from the clue: _____.

File label

Hanging-file label: write the broad pretend label for this observatory decision point: _____.

Path one

Path one: write the first possible path with a blue pencil mark, chart corner, or file tab: _____.

Compare clue

Compare clue: name one chart clue that helps the keeper compare which path fits better: _____.

Consequence note

Consequence note: write what the chosen path changes on the pretend chart page: _____.

Quiet option: write only the choice, the two path titles, and the file label before adding more: _____.

Take-home line: tuck the page in the hanging file and add one new chart clue later: _____.

Clue Label Tower Museum Story Decision Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out a hanging file, blank page, pencil, and this card beside a pretend tower-museum label stack: _____.

Writer: plan one invented museum character choice on paper and keep the tower labels fictional: _____.



Clue Label Tower Museum

Choice

Character choice: name the fictional label keeper's choice at the tower museum decision point: _____.

Path two

Path two: write a second possible path using a different label order or tower note: _____.

Chosen path

Chosen path: choose the path the label keeper uses and explain why that clue helped: _____.

File label

Hanging-file label: write the broad pretend label for this tower museum decision point: _____.

Path one

Path one: write the first possible path using a clue label, shelf card, or file tab: _____.

Compare clue

Compare clue: name one clue label that helps compare the two possible paths: _____.

Consequence note

Consequence note: write what changes in the pretend museum tower after the chosen path: _____.

Quiet option: fill the choice blank, both path blanks, and one file label before adding the note: _____. **Take-home line:** save the page in the hanging file and add one more clue label later: _____.

Margin Note Market Story Decision Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: place one hanging file, blank page, pencil, and this card beside a pretend margin-note stall map: _____.

Writer: draft one invented note keeper choice on paper with only pretend market and margin details: _____.



Margin Note Market

Choice

Character choice: name the fictional note keeper's choice at the margin-note decision point: _____.

Path two

Path two: write a second possible path using a different margin note or paper signal: _____.

Chosen path

Chosen path: choose the note keeper's path and explain the paper clue that made it fit: _____.

File label

Hanging-file label: write the broad pretend label for this margin-note decision point: _____.

Path one

Path one: write the first possible path using a margin note, stall tag, or file divider: _____.

Compare clue

Compare clue: name one small note clue that helps compare which path matches the story page: _____.

Consequence note

Consequence note: write what changes at the pretend margin-note market after the chosen path: _____.

Quiet option: write just the choice, path one, path two, and file label for now: _____. **Take-home line:** place the page in the hanging file and add one extra margin note later: _____.

Revision River Ferry Story Decision Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out this card, one hanging file, blank page, and pencil beside a pretend revision river ferry chart: _____.

Writer: plan one invented ferry character choice on paper and keep every river detail pretend and gentle: _____.



Revision River Ferry

Choice

Character choice: name the fictional ferry guide's choice at the revision river decision point: _____.

Path two

Path two: write a different possible path using another paper crossing note or tab: _____.

Chosen path

Chosen path: choose the path the ferry guide follows and name the clue that tipped the choice: _____.

File label

Hanging-file label: write the broad pretend label for this revision river decision point: _____.

Path one

Path one: write the first possible path using a revision note, ferry tag, or file marker: _____.

Compare clue

Compare clue: name one revision clue that helps compare the two paths before choosing: _____.

Consequence note

Consequence note: write what changes on the pretend river page after the chosen path: _____.

Quiet option: fill only the choice, two path names, and hanging-file label first: _____. **Take-home line:** keep the page in the hanging file and add one new consequence note later: _____.